HELLO,

WE ARE...
THE ROOT

Two dog-loving, data science students living in Berlin





Team: TheRoot
Tim · Amin ·

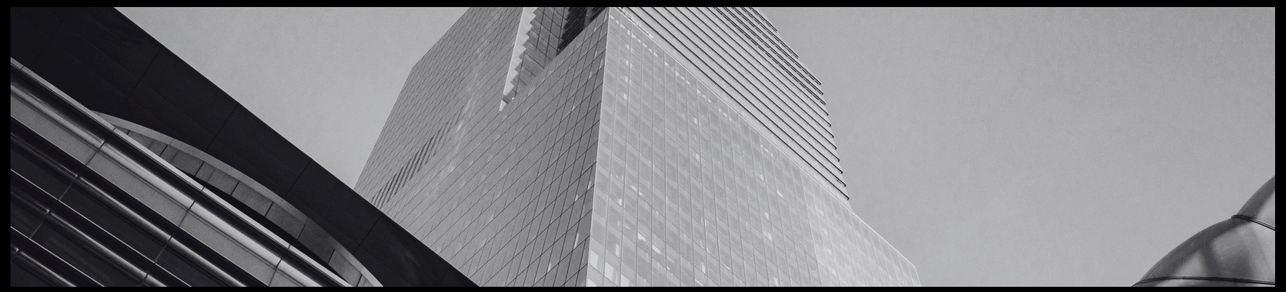
Capstone · Music discovery

9th October 2026

tastey

Music discovery on your terms

A TASTE BRIDGE PROJECT



THE PROBLEM

Music recommenders can be great but they keep you in one corner or throw you somewhere very random

Too familiar

Near-copies of what you already play.
Safe and comfortable but limited for exploration.

Too random

Something new but with no thread back to where you started. Nobody asks how adventurous you want to be today.

WHAT WE BELIEVE



We had a vision...

Transparent, user-controlled music discovery that breaks listeners out of filter bubbles.

Built for active listeners who want more than the algorithm keeps serving, and the platforms that host them.

So, we set a mission

Let every listener should choose how familiar or adventurous today feels and show why each track belongs.

We want engagement and retention through novelty that doesn't lose relevance.

OUR SOLUTION...



TRY IT NOW

mrln77-tastey-demo.hf.space

01 Pick a starting seed track

Open tastey.
Search a song, tap a genre, or hit Surprise me.

02 Set the dial

Slide from Home to Adventure and watch the list change.
Each pick shows how many "bridgons" away it sits from your start.

03 Save and explore

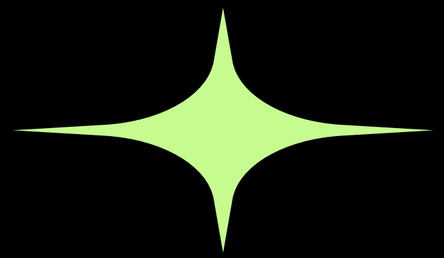
Save what you like, make it your new starting seed then open the taste map to see where your taste went.

ON YOUR PHONE OR LAPTOP

Scan to open

THE DIFFERENCE

	typical recommenders	tastey
How new it gets?	Decided for you	You choose with one dial
Why this track?	Rarely explained	Taste distance and the Taste Map
Starting point	Depends on your history	One track you pick right now
New listener?	Needs history first	Works from day one from sound alone
“Similar” means	What others clicked, genre tags	How it sounds, checked by human ears



HOW IT WORKS

1. Listen with a pre-trained ear

An existing audio model (Discogs-EffNet), trained by others on a huge music catalogue, listens once to every 30-second clip.

(We evaluated this model against our own)

2. Give every track a fingerprint

1,280 numbers describing rhythm, texture, instruments and mood.
Close fingerprints sound alike.
No genre label is used.

3. Rank then let the dial choose

Sort the whole catalogue by closeness to your start.
The dial picks where in that ranking to read.
Each click is a fast lookup.

24,757

open-licence tracks from FMA (Free Music Archive)
each given a 1,280-number fingerprint





THE DIAL

The dial lets you chooses which slice of that ranking you hear.
Bridge caps any single genre;
Adventure steers toward other genres and eras.

HOME ~1-40

BRIDGE ~81-420

ADVENTURE ~1,400-6000

Gaps between the bands: ranks 41–80 and 421–1,400 are deliberately left out, so each level feels different from the one before.

TESTED BY EAR

Listeners heard pairs of 30-second clips, with no names or genres, and rated 1–5:
how alike do they sound?

Random pairs were mixed in as a floor.

0.73 out of 1.0

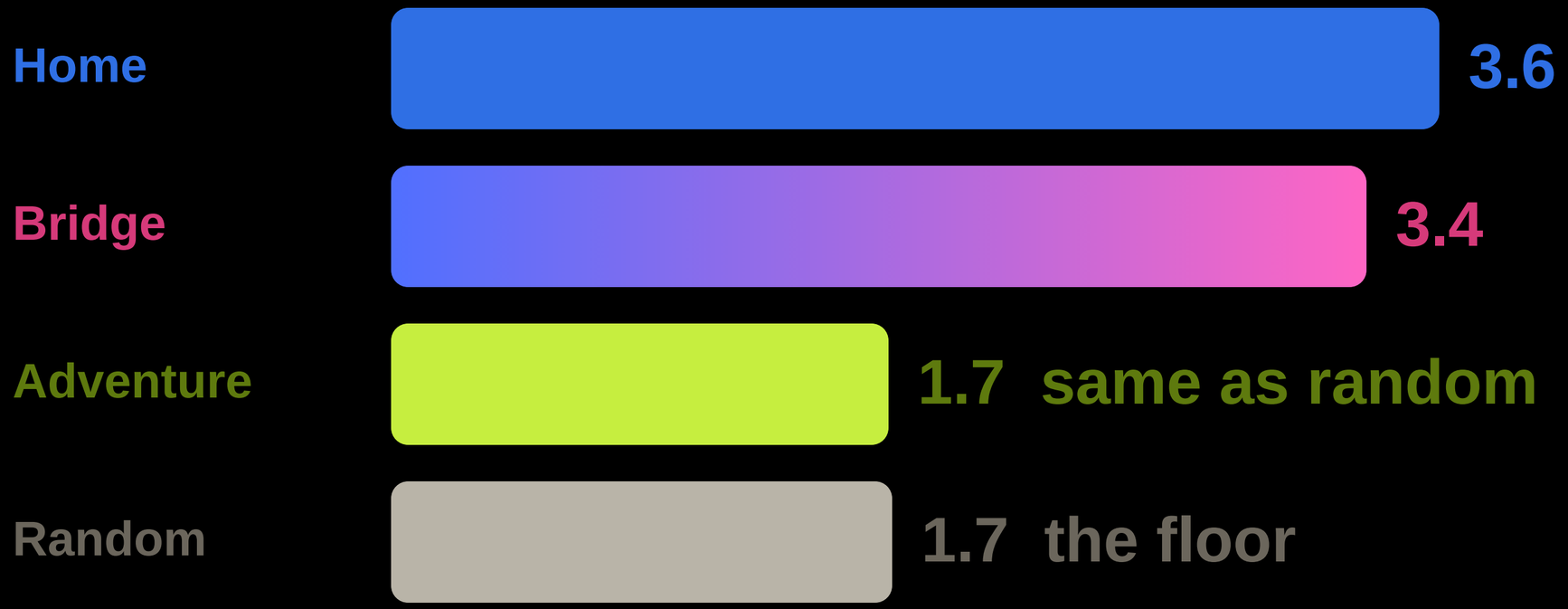
EffNet's agreement with listeners

0.33 out of 1.0

our own features: 0.33

LIVE APP

Home and Bridge clearly beat random and the order holds
But Adventure scores the same as random: it currently jumps too far.



Mean listener score per pair, 1–5 (how alike do they sound?) · 6 new seeds, 42 pairs from the live app, 6 raters, pre-registered

WHAT WORKS
“I like how I feel like I’m falling into a bit of a rabbit hole with no expectations”

“Great for exploring new music”

“The flexibility of searching and choosing”

“Great platform for new unheard artists”

WHAT NEEDS WORK
how to click on adventure or bridge

more intuitive and hand holding initally

Even more clarity in how tracks are connected so I can search similar tracks

ASKED FOR
More artist information

Improved terminology

Searching in other languages

Better Taste map usability

USER FEEDBACK

scan the QR code at the end to help us grow through feedback

NEXT STEPS

Ideas & Improvements for the future

LOCATION
What's playing in the city you're in or a location of your choice

DECADE/YEAR BASED SEARCHING
Easily finding music of a specific decade or year

WEATHER
Recommendations based on weather while still bridging

MOOD
Say how you feel; it picks the start

ACTIVITY & HEALTH
Match tempo to your activity/run, e.g. Apple Watch

ADVENTURE DIAL
Adjust the Adventure ranks then re-test by ear

SMART NUDGES
Suggest when to try Bridge or Adventure

YOUR HISTORY
Listening and taste journey data

LANGUAGE
Searching in other languages for music of other countries

Team: TheRoot
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Thank you for listening

9th October 2026

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Keep playing & give us feedback

https://forms.gle/HtAGKEDxqRQwBc1C7